you? It is incorrect. If I can't do this at twenty-two people, then I can't do it with fifty or 500 or whatever number they gave you.'

When pushed on the numbers, he responded, 'The fact is that I'm one, I've created thirty-six state units and each of those state units are doing whatever they can do. With their own limited resources, they have their own things because I can't be having an opinion on what's happening in Andhra politics, right? So, I basically created a cookie-cutter model which has now been implemented in all our states. So, people in Assam are doing it, people in Bengal are doing it, people in Odisha are doing it. It's a very efficient way of doing it. Of course, it's very people-centric. If I have a good guy in any of the states, that state is much, much more robust than say a state with a less talented person.'

Another area where the BJP focused its attention was WhatsApp. In September 2018, *Hindustan Times* reported that the BJP was creating a new kind of worker: a 'cell phone pramukh'. The idea was to have around 9,00,000 of these, one for almost every polling booth or station. (India has 10,35,000 booths in all.) Prime Minister Modi, the newspaper reported, met a group of senior BJP leaders that month, and the details of this campaign were presented by a senior official in his office.[49] By December 2018, the BJP's national general secretary (organisation), Ram Lal, publicly announced that 'a chain of WhatsApp groups linking Panna Pramukhs up to national level leaders will be set up'. Panna Pramukhs are booth-level BJP workers who are responsible for keeping in touch with voters named in one page (panna) of an electoral roll in a constituency. (The BJP's structure of IT heads and panna pramukhs is detailed in Chapter 8.)[50]

While the Congress was trying to replicate Modi's 2014 digital strategy, focusing on Rahul's messaging, the BJP was already working at much more intricate and subtle levels. As one social-media manager told me, 'The BJP worked at much more local levels, infiltrating WhatsApp groups in RWA societies, office groups and alumni or friend networks. While Congress was sharing official messages of its leaders, a lot of pro-BJP messaging was done in these networks.'